

CCNS — Install Guide

Install — CCNS (CC Hair & Head Search)

CCNS installs like a normal .pak mod, with one important step: it must be **active in your load order**, not just present in the Mods folder, so its Script Extender script runs. The whole process takes a couple of minutes.

Prerequisites

1. **Baldur's Gate 3**, Patch 8 or later.
2. **BG3 Script Extender (BG3SE)** installed and working (version 29 or later). If you don't have it, get it from <https://bg3.community/> — the installation guide is on their site. When BG3 launches with Script Extender active, you'll see its console window.
3. **BG3 Mod Manager (BG3MM)** — strongly recommended. You can get it from its NexusMods page. CCNS needs to be in your active load order, and a mod manager makes that one click.
4. *(Optional / recommended)* **BG3 ImprovedUI** — the Patch 8 fork, NexusMods mod **16649** (*ImpUI_P8_Fork*). Not required; CCNS runs without it, but the two are tested together.

Install

1. **Download and unzip** CCNS-1.0.0.zip. Inside you'll find CCNS_HairHeadSearch.pak plus these documents.
2. **Copy the .pak into your BG3 Mods folder.** Open File Explorer, paste this into the address bar, and press Enter:

%LocalAppData%\Larian Studios\Baldur's Gate 3\Mods

Copy CCNS_HairHeadSearch.pak into that folder.
3. **Activate it in your load order.** Open BG3 Mod Manager and refresh its mod list (F5 or the refresh button).
 - If “**CCNS Hair & Head Search**” appears in the right-hand **Inactive/Overrides** pane, **drag it into the left-hand Active list** (or right-click it and choose “**Add to Load Order**”).
 - This step matters: CCNS overrides a base-game UI file, so a mod manager may park it in the Overrides pane by default. While it's there, the visual labels load **but the Script Extender script — which provides the mod names, tile numbers, and search panel — does not run.** It must be in the **active** list.
 - Click **Save** to write your load order.

4. **Launch BG3.** Start a New Game and go to the appearance step (or open the Magic Mirror / a mid-game appearance editor). Open the **Head or Hair** grid — you should see a name and source-mod under each tile. Then press Ctrl + Shift + H to open the search panel.

Using it

► **IMPORTANT — HOW TO GET THE THUMBNAIL NUMBERS:** press Ctrl + Shift + H on the **Head or Hair** screen to open the panel, then **click back and forth between the Hair and Head tabs until the numbers appear on the thumbnails in both** — usually 1–2 round trips. The numbers should then be permanently assigned; if they're ever removed during the game, repeat the round trip when you re-enter the CC panels.

- **Open / close the search panel:** Ctrl + Shift + H, while on the Head or Hair screen. The hotkey does nothing on other screens (by design); closing works anywhere.
- **Search:** type in the panel's box to filter by hair/head **name** or **source mod**.
- **Apply a result:** click it — the hair/head changes immediately.
- **Walk through matches:** **Previous** / **Next** buttons; the status line shows the match number and the tile number to look for in the grid.

Troubleshooting

No labels, no panel — nothing changed

- Confirm **Script Extender is loaded** (its console window appears when BG3 runs). Without it, CCNS does nothing.
- Confirm **CCNS is in your active load order**, not the Overrides pane (see step 3 above). This is the single most common cause.
- Check the Script Extender console for a [CCNS] v11.11 loaded ... line at startup. If it's absent, the script isn't loading — re-check load order.

The panel opens, but the thumbnails have no numbers

- Click back and forth between the **Hair and Head tabs** 1–2 times. BG3 only repaints the tile labels when a tab is rebuilt, so the round trip is what makes the numbers show. Once they appear they stay for the rest of the session.

Ctrl + Shift + H does nothing

- The panel only opens while you're on the **Head or Hair** screen — the hotkey is intentionally a no-op elsewhere. Make sure you're on the hair/head picker.
- If it still won't open there, another mod may be binding Ctrl + Shift + H.

Labels show, but the panel lists everything as "Vanilla"

- The Script Extender script isn't running, or hasn't run yet. Make sure CCNS is **active in load order** (step 3) and launch the game at least once after enabling it.

Labels don't appear, or appear wrong, after installing another UI mod

- Another mod may be replacing CCLib_k.xaml or CCLib_c.xaml. Only one such override can win, decided by load order. Most notably, **Customizer's Compendium (mod 10)** conflicts; use the **Patch 7 Ready** version (mod **12111**) instead. Put CCNS after other UI mods in your load order if you want it to win.

Controller: labels don't show

- The game load